

CreatorOS

Product Requirements Document

Version 1.0 · April 2026

1. Product Overview

CreatorOS is a content planning and management SaaS app built specifically for aspiring TikTok creators. It helps users capture ideas, plan videos across content pillars, build shot lists, manage a posting calendar, and use AI to generate scripts, hooks, and creative direction — all in one place.

The core problem it solves: aspiring creators hold too many ideas in their heads, lack a system to stay intentional, and feel overwhelmed by the content creation process. CreatorOS gives them the structure and confidence to show up consistently.

2. Target User

Primary user

An aspiring TikTok creator who is just starting out. They have ideas but no system. They want to build a personal brand and create consistent, intentional content but feel overwhelmed by the process.

User characteristics

- Has ideas but stores them inconsistently — notes app, voice memos, or just in their head
- Wants to post intentionally rather than reactively
- Cares about the quality and feel of their content
- May be balancing content creation with a full-time job or career transition
- Is motivated by the long-term goal of personal branding and potential brand deals

Example persona

A contract coordinator transitioning into AI product management, documenting their journey on TikTok. They have three content pillars — cinematic content, lifestyle/career, and personal finance — and want their feed to feel cohesive, intentional, and professionally crafted.

3. Content Pillars Concept

Pillars are the content categories a creator builds their TikTok identity around. CreatorOS is built around this concept from the ground up — every idea, video, and piece of content is tagged to a pillar.

Users set up their pillars during onboarding. There is no hard limit on the number of pillars, but the app recommends starting with three to maintain focus and a balanced feed.

Example pillars

Cinematic	Lifestyle / career	Finance
Polished, color-graded cinematic content	Day in the life, career transition journey	Personal investing and finance journey

4. MVP Feature Set

The following four features make up the core MVP. They were prioritized based on directly solving the target user's pain of holding ideas in their head and lacking a system to stay intentional.

4.1 Capture-to-post pipeline

A kanban-style pipeline that tracks every video idea through four stages: Idea, Scripted, Filmed, and Posted. Each video card is tagged to a content pillar and can be expanded to reveal the associated script and shot list inline.

- Four pipeline stages: Idea, Scripted, Filmed, Posted
- Each card tagged to a content pillar with color coding
- Expandable card dropdown showing script and shot list
- One-click stage advancement
- Pillar filter tabs to view pipeline by content category

4.2 Pillar organization

Every piece of content in the app is organized by content pillar. Users can view all ideas and videos filtered by pillar, and a pillar balance widget shows if they are being consistent across all categories.

- Pillar setup during onboarding — unlimited pillars, three recommended
- Color-coded pillar tags across the entire app
- Pillar balance analytics widget on the dashboard
- Filter any view by pillar

4.3 Shot list builder

A structured shot list builder attached to every video idea. Users can manually add shots or use AI assistance (Pro) to auto-generate a shot list from the video title and script. Shot lists are visible inline when a video card is expanded in the pipeline.

- Manual shot list creation per video
- Shot list visible inline in the pipeline card dropdown
- Numbered shots with drag-to-reorder (future iteration)
- AI shot list generation from title and script (Pro feature)

4.4 Content calendar

A monthly calendar view showing scheduled posting dates. Each calendar day shows which video is planned, color coded by pillar. Helps users visualize their posting rhythm and ensure pillar variety across their feed.

- Monthly calendar view
- Pillar color coding on calendar days
- Planned posting date per video
- Posting reminder notifications (Pro feature)
- Auto-publishing to TikTok via API (Version 2 — post-MVP)

5. Pro Features (Paid Tier)

Pro features are designed to save serious creators real time and give them a creative edge. The AI assistant is the primary paid feature that drives upgrades.

5.1 AI creative assistant

A context-aware AI chat interface that knows the user's content pillars, their current pipeline, and their style inspirations. Users can ask it to generate hooks, script outlines, shot lists, and video ideas tailored to their specific content strategy.

- Chat interface embedded in the app sidebar under a Pro section
- Knows user's active pillars and pipeline context
- Style inspiration board — users add TikTok creators they admire
- AI generates output styled after saved creator inspirations
- Quick prompt chips for common requests (generate hook, build shot list, etc.)
- "Save to pipeline" button on any AI-generated output

Style inspiration — creator search

When a user adds a new creator to their style inspiration board, the app identifies the creator and summarizes their content style. The AI uses this context when generating scripts, hooks, and shot lists.

- Leverages AI training knowledge for well-known creators
- Web search fallback for newer or niche creators
- Confirmation step shows a style summary for user to verify before saving
- Multiple creators can be saved and toggled on/off per session

5.2 AI script and shot list generation

From any idea in the pipeline, users can trigger AI generation of a full script outline and shot list with one click. The AI uses the video title, pillar context, and style inspirations to produce relevant, personalized output.

5.3 Posting reminders

Users set a posting goal (e.g. 3x per week) and receive reminders when they have a planned post coming up. Keeps users accountable to their content schedule without being intrusive.

5.4 Advanced pillar analytics

A dashboard widget showing pillar balance, posting frequency by pillar, and pipeline health across all stages. Helps creators identify which content categories they are neglecting.

6. Monetization

Model

Freemium subscription. Free tier provides enough value to build the habit; paid tier unlocks AI features and removes limits. Monthly subscription pricing.

Pricing

- Free tier: \$0/month
- Pro tier: \$8 - \$12/month (exact price TBD based on market validation)

Free vs Pro feature breakdown

Feature	Free	Pro
Pipeline (ideas)	Up to 10	Unlimited

Feature	Free	Pro
Content pillars	Up to 3	Unlimited
Manual shot list builder	✓	✓
Content calendar	✓	✓
AI script generation	—	✓
AI shot list generation	—	✓
AI creative assistant	—	✓
Style inspiration board	—	✓
Posting reminders	—	✓
Pillar analytics	—	✓

7. Onboarding Flow

The onboarding flow is designed to get a new user from zero to their first captured idea in under two minutes. Every step is animated with staggered text transitions to create a premium, intentional feel.

Onboarding steps

1. **Welcome screen** — Single headline that speaks to the user's core pain. "Stop holding your content ideas in your head." One CTA: Get started.
2. **Name entry** — Simple first name field. Personalizes the rest of the experience.
3. **Pillar setup** — User adds their content pillars. No hard limit. App suggests three with adaptive hint text that updates as they add more. Minimum one to continue.
4. **First idea capture** — Prompts user to drop their first video idea. Title and pillar tag only — low friction. Can be skipped.
5. **Pipeline peek** — Shows the user's first idea sitting in the Idea column of their pipeline. Brief one-line explanation of each stage. This is the "time to value" moment.
6. **Dashboard** — User enters the full app. No further hand-holding unless they ask.

Animation note

All onboarding screens use staggered text animations — headlines, sublines, and CTAs fade and slide in sequentially rather than appearing all at once. This creates a premium feel and slows the user down to actually read each step. Recommended implementation: Framer Motion (React) or CSS keyframe animations with staggered delays.

8. Product Discovery Summary

The following risks were assessed during discovery before any build decisions were made.

Value risk — will users use or pay for this?

Hypothesized based on personal experience as the target user, not yet validated externally. I hold content ideas in my head, write scripts in scattered notes apps, and skip shot lists entirely — the app directly solves pain I feel myself. The AI assistant is the primary paid feature I expect users would open their wallet for, as it removes the blank page problem and saves real creative time. External validation is in progress: I am currently running user interviews with other creators to pressure-test these assumptions before locking v2 scope.

Usability risk — can users figure it out?

Mitigated by the onboarding flow. The pipeline, pillar system, and shot list builder are intuitive by design. The AI assistant has quick prompt chips and action cards to guide first-time usage without a tutorial.

Feasibility risk — what was descoped?

- Auto-publishing to TikTok via API — technically feasible but deferred to Version 2 due to build complexity and the fact that the MVP user has not yet built a posting habit
- Automatic TikTok page scraping for creator style analysis — removed due to TikTok API restrictions and ToS concerns. Replaced with user-input style inspiration board backed by AI knowledge and web search
- Hook generator — identified as a nice-to-have, absorbed into the AI creative assistant as a core prompt type rather than a standalone feature

9. Future Roadmap (Post-MVP)

The v2 roadmap stays anchored to the same core problem as v1: creators lose ideas and struggle to stay consistent. v2 is about solving that problem more deeply, not expanding surface area.

Version 2 — solving what v1 couldn't

v1 proved the pipeline concept. v2 addresses the three biggest friction points surfaced in dogfooding and early user interviews, all of which sit directly on the core problem.

- Mobile idea capture — v1 is desktop-first, but the majority of idea moments happen on a phone. If ideas can't be captured where they happen, the pipeline starts empty.
- AI script generation — removes the blank-page friction at the Idea → Scripted transition, which is where cards currently stall the longest.
- AI shot list generation — completes the idea-to-ready-to-film flow without manual shot planning, which most users skip entirely today.

Later considerations — not next

The following features become interesting only after v1's core loop is proven and users are consistently shipping content. Listed for transparency, not planned for the next release.

- TikTok auto-publishing via official API — solves the posting step, which is downstream of the core pain.
- Multi-platform expansion (Instagram Reels, YouTube Shorts) — a distribution concern, not an idea-capture one.
- Performance analytics integration — an optimization feature for creators who are already shipping consistently, which the v1 user is not yet.
- Collaboration for creators with editors or managers — serves a different user (creators with teams) and is likely a different product entirely.